SIMPLIFIED ENGLISH TEACHING AND LEARNING

A Sharp Focus on Primary School Leaving Certificate Examinations

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Chapter 1

PARTS OF SPEECH

- Parts of speech are the grammatical categories to which different words are assigned, based on meaning, structure and function in a sentence.
- In English, there are eight word classes called **parts of speech**. These are
    - Noun
    - Pronoun
    - Adjective
    - Verb
    - Adverb
    - Preposition
    - Conjunction
    - Interjection

1. THE NOUN
    - A noun is a word that names a person, a place, an object or an idea.

Examples of names of things

- mother
- Dan
- brother
- woman
- teacher

- mayor
- father
- Peter

Examples of names of places

- City
- Blantyre
- Kitchen
- Lusaka
- Nkhotakota

Examples of names of things or objects

- train
- lamp
- bread
- tree

Examples of ideas

- grief
- desire
- democracy
- speed
- bravery

COMMON AND PROPER NOUNS

COMMON NOUNS

- A common noun is a noun used to name any common object.

- Common nouns usually begin with small letters except when they begin a sentence.

Examples of common nouns

- boy
- month
- day
- school
- lake
- pencil
- child
- uncle
- scissors
- street
- valley
- airplane

Note: *These nouns do not name a particular or specific place, person or thing*.

PROPER NOUNS

- A proper noun is a noun used to name a specific or particular person, place or thing. It usually begins with a capital letter.

Examples of proper nouns

- Tamanda
- Peter
- Monica

- Lilongwe
- Blantyre
- January
- Lusaka
- Monday
- April
- Joyce
- Republic day
- Kamuzu day

Note: *Nouns of more than one word like living room, Kamuzu day, Republic day, are considered one noun.*

COLLECTIVE NOUNS

- These are nouns that name a group of people or things of the same kind.

Examples

- A <u>set</u> of tools
- A <u>bunch</u> of keys
- A <u>bunch</u> of bananas
- A <u>fleet</u> of cars
- A <u>pack</u> of cards

- A bundle of stacks
- A packet of cigarettes
- A heap of stones
- A flock of sheep
- A flock of birds
- A herd of cattle
- A team of players
- A board of directors
- A panel of judges
- A swarm of bees
- A swarm of locusts
- A wreath of flowers
- A crowd of people
- A gang of thieves

Note: *A collective noun can either take a singular verb or a plural verb*.

Examples

- ✓ The committee has reached a final decision (singular).
- ✓ The committee are not working today (plural).

ABSTRACT NOUNS

- An abstract noun names an idea or state, something we can feel or think about but has no physical qualities.

- It refers to the things we cannot see or touch.

Examples

- ✓ Poverty is an enemy to development.
- ✓ A lot of people are afraid of death.
- ✓ We were treated with kindness.
- ✓ Ignorance is a disease.
- ✓ Health is better than wealth.
- ✓ We now have freedom.

2. PRONOUNS

- A pronoun is a word used in place of one or more nouns. It may stand for a person, place, thing or idea.
- The pronoun gives the noun a rest.

Examples

- ✓ He offered to help her.
- ✓ I will go with them.
- ✓ She is reading it.
- ✓ He is kicking it.

KINDS OF PRONOUNS

A. PERSONAL PRONOUNS

- They are pronouns that stand for a person who is speaking, or the person spoken to or about.
- They denote things or persons without precisely naming them.

Examples

I, me, we, us, you, he, him, she, they, them, her.

B. POSSESSIVE PRONOUNS

- They are pronouns that are used to show ownership and possession.

Examples

- ✓ This dog is hers.
- ✓ The pen is yours.
- ✓ The hat is his.
- ✓ This house is mine.
- ✓ That book is ours.
- ✓ The goats are theirs.
- ✓ This fur is hers.

C. REFLEXIVE PRONOUNS

- These are pronouns used when the action expressed by the verb passes back to the subject.

Examples

- ✓ The little girl hurt herself.
- ✓ The baby cannot dress itself.
- ✓ They enjoyed themselves at the party.
- ✓ We taught ourselves to read.
- ✓ He cut himself with a knife.

D. EMPHATIC PRONOUNS

- These are pronouns used to emphasize a point.
- They usually appear or come immediately after the subject.

Examples

- ✓ I myself saw him do it.
- ✓ He himself stole the oranges.
- ✓ They themselves made a mistake.

E. DISTRIBUTIVE PRONOUNS

- These are pronouns used to refer to individual or separate members of a group.

Examples

- ✓ Either of these is good.
- ✓ Each of the boys was present.
- ✓ Neither of these is wrong.
- ✓ Each comes up in his turn.

F. INDEFINITE PRONOUNS

- These are pronouns that refer to persons or things generally rather than specifically.

Examples

- ✓ Anybody can do this work.
- ✓ She was given something to take home.
- ✓ Someone knocked me down.
- ✓ Some of us attended the meeting.

- ✓ Nobody knows where they are.
- ✓ Someone is to blame for that.

G. INTERROGATIVE PRONOUNS

- ➢ They are pronouns that are used to ask questions.

Examples

- ✓ What is your favourite game?
- ✓ Who are you?
- ✓ Which do you want?
- ✓ Whom did you meet?

H. DEMONSTRATIVE PRONOUNS

- ➢ These are pronouns used to point out at something.
- ➢ They take the form of pronouns as a word class or part of speech only if they do not immediately precede a noun or an antecedent.

Examples

- ✓ This is perfect.
- ✓ Those are fine.
- ✓ These are good.
- ✓ That is being selfish.

3. ADJECTIVES

- ➢ Adjectives are words that make the meaning of other words more exact by describing or limiting them.
- ➢ They qualify a noun or a pronoun.

- Adjectives answer the questions ***"what kind?"***, ***"how many?"*** or "***how much?"***

Examples

- They are happy children.
- Madalo is a busy housewife.
- Today is a sunny day.
- These countries are at peace.
- You can read any book.
- There are five people here.

- **Sometimes adjectives do not come before the word they qualify.**

Examples

- ✓ The box is empty.
- ✓ He is rude.
- ✓ That boy is intelligent.
- ✓ The team was eager.
- ✓ The river is deep.

- **Sometimes more than one adjectives may qualify one antecedent (a noun or a pronoun).**

Examples

- ✓ The impatient, angry crowd pushed forward (in this case, adjectives "***impatient***" and "***angry***" are qualifying one antecedent which is "crowd").
- ✓ The stupid thin boy has faced it (in this case, adjectives "***stupid***" and ***"thin***" are qualifying one antecedent which is "boy").

THE ARTICLE

- Articles perform the functions of adjectives.
- There are only three articles: “a”, “the” and “an”.

TYPES OF ARTICLES

- There are two types of articles and these are

(i) Indefinite article

(ii) Definite article

INDEFINITE ARTICLES

- **“A”** and **“an”** are indefinite articles. They come before a singular noun and are used to show generality.

USES OF **“A”** AND **“AN”**

- “A” is generally used before a consonant (b, c, d, f, etc) sound while “an” is used before a vowel (a, e, i, o and u) sound.
- The emphasis here is on sound.

Examples

- A book
- A cow
- A peacock
- An elephant
- An egg
- An animal

❖ Words beginning with h-sound and unstressed vowel not infrequently

have “an” as well as “a”.

Examples

- An hour
- An honorable man
- An historian

- Before “y” and “w”, whether written or not, only “a” is used.

Examples

- A union (“y” sound)
- A youth (“y” sound)
- A unanimous rising (“y” sound)

- **“A”** and **“an”** are derived from the numeral “one” and remains something of its numeral value.

Examples

- ✓ We cannot fight fraud in **a** day (one day).
- ✓ Wait **a** minute (one minute).
- ✓ Come again in **an** hour (one hour).

DEFINITE ARTICLE: ***“the”***

- **“The”** often marks the noun to which it is joined as the name of something which both the speaker and the hearer can separate from others of the same class.

Examples

- ✓ The man has three million kwacha (This means both the speaker and the hearer know about this man).

- ✓ This is the person.

Some proper names demand the definite article.

Examples

- ➢ The Pacific Ocean.
- ➢ The sun.
- ➢ The moon.

KINDS OF ADJECTIVES

A. DESCRIPTIVE ADJECTIVES

- ➢ They are adjectives that show quality or state of a thing.

Examples

- ✓ This river is not deep.
- ✓ Uwemi is a brave girl.
- ✓ That is a short man.
- ✓ Blantyre is a large city.
- ✓ Chisomo is an intelligent boy.
- ✓ Mrs. Malenga is a beautiful woman.
- ✓ His father is a poor man.

B. PROPER ADJECTIVES

These are adjectives formed from proper nouns.

They begin with capital letters, just like proper nouns.

Examples

- ✓ Lumbani is a Malawian singer.
- ✓ She is a Tanzanian trader.
- ✓ Those Spanish dancers have come.
- ✓ Oliver Mtukudzi is a Zimbabwean musician.

C. POSSESSIVE ADJECTIVES

These are adjectives that show to whom an object belongs.

Examples

- ✓ Its legs are dirty.
- ✓ Their books are clean.
- ✓ This is my house.
- ✓ Our home is good.
- ✓ Her books are on the floor.
- ✓ Their shirts are tidy.

D. INTERROGATIVE ADJECTIVES

These are adjectives used to ask questions.

Examples

- ✓ Which book do you want?
- ✓ What time is it?
- ✓ What name shall we give the baby?
- ✓ Which road goes to Mzuzu?
- ✓ Which pencil is yours?

E. DEMONSTRATIVE ADJECTIVES

They are adjectives used to point at objects.

Examples

- ✓ This book is interesting.
- ✓ That boy is intelligent.
- ✓ These hoes are theirs.
- ✓ This reason is not enough.
- ✓ What is that girl's name?

F. NUMERICAL ADJECTIVES

These are adjectives which indicate exactly how many things there are or in what order they are.

Examples

- ✓ Six people were chosen for the trip.
- ✓ Chisomo drank three cups of water.
- ✓ August is the eighth month of the year.
- ✓ Twenty players were included in the squad.
- ✓ She gained second place in class.

G. INDEFINITE ADJECTIVES

They state a number of things without stating exactly what the number is.

Examples

- ✓ There are many houses here.

- ✓ All the dogs were shot by the hunters.
- ✓ Several people attended the meeting.
- ✓ Some girls took part in the race.

H. DISTRIBUTIVE ADJECTIVES

These are adjectives that show that things are taken separately.

Examples

- ✓ Each learner received a prize.
- ✓ I do not support either side.
- ✓ She was told to take medicine every two hours.

I. QUANTITATIVE ADJECTIVES

These are adjectives that show how much of an object is meant.

Examples

- ✓ She doesn't have much money.
- ✓ Lumbani ate the whole loaf of bread.

4. VERBS

A verb is word that expresses an action in a sentence.

Examples

- ✓ I like mangoes.
- ✓ The girl is running to school.

- ✓ The learners are all happy.
- ✓ They walked through the gate.
- ✓ The boy went home.
- ✓ The children are cutting grass.
- ✓ He will be seeing his father tomorrow.

The verb can be expressed in the past, present and future.

Examples

- The baby cried (past).
- The baby cries (present simple).
- The baby will cry (future).
-

ACTION VERBS

An action verb is a verb that expresses mental or physical action.

Examples

- The owls hooted all night.
- The lioness played with her cubs.
- We studied our history at the library.

LINKING VERBS

These are the verbs that make a statement by connecting the subject with a word in the predicate that describes it.

A linking verb does not show action but connects the subject with a word in the predicate.

Examples

- I am a photographer.
- He has been sick.
- We would have been early.
- Those oranges were sweet.
- Lumbani stayed calm in the midst of the tremor.
- Uwemi looked pale.
- We all felt excited after the game.
- This corn smells fish.

AUXILIARY VERBS

They are verbs which help other verbs to form their tense, voice and mood. They are also called helping verbs.

They help the main verb to express action or make a statement.

Examples

- I am going home.
- The boys are playing volleyball.
- The rat was killed by the cat.
- Caroline can't swim.
- Lucy did see the snake.
- Lumbani will vote for presidency.
- Many Malawians can speak a second language.
- The baby has been named Watipaso.

- May God bless you.

5. THE ADVERB

An adverb is a word that modifies a verb, an adjective or another adverb.

Examples

- Fire destroyed the home yesterday.
- Tadala walked slowly.
- The shirt is very clean.
- Do not drive too fast.
- Uwemi is very intelligent.
- The fire blazed dangerously for everyone to enter.

TYPES OF ADVERBS

A. ADVERBS OF MANNER

They describe how the action takes place.

They usually end in “ly”

Examples

- Uwemi writes neatly.
- That woman walks slowly.
- The man drove carelessly.
- The children ran hurriedly.
- The boxer fought skillfully.
- The children behaved badly.
- His father rebuked him strongly.

B. ADVERBS OF DEGREE

These are adverbs that indicate the extent or degree to which something happens.

Examples

- The coffee is too hot to drink.
- Tiyamike is a very clever girl.
- The question is rather difficult.
- He reads quite fluently.
- Lumbani walked so slowly that she was left behind.

C. INTERROGATIVE ADVERBS

They are used to introduce questions.

Examples

- When are you coming here?
- How are you?
- Why did you leave him?
- Where is that fruit?
- When will you leave?

D. RELATIVE ADVERBS

These are adverbs used to introduce adverb clauses.

Examples

- I saw them when I was in Nkhotakota.

- They asked me why I was late.
- We shall eat where there is good soup.
- When you saw me I was ill.
- I shall go where they go.

E. ADVERBS OF TIME

They show when the action of the verb takes place.

Examples

- She did the work yesterday.
- Write me a letter soon.
- Our examinations will start tomorrow.
- I can see you now.

F. ADVERBS OF FREQUENCY

They indicate how often something happens.

Examples

- She drinks water regularly.
- They come hear frequently.
- I often meet him here.
- I have never met her.

G. ADVERBS OF PLACE

They show where the action of the verb takes place.

Examples

- They slept here.

- Lumbani went abroad.
- The bird flew out.
- They decided to leave here.

6. PREPOSITIONS

A preposition is a word that shows the relationship of a noun or a pronoun to some other words in a sentence.

Examples

- The thieves are on the runway.
- They walked through the gate.
- They are in the house.
- She is coming from the market.
- The boy raced down the street.
- The books are under the table.
- This chapter is about prepositions.
- She shall meet at the crossroads.
- Is he inside the house?
- I could hardly see the man through the window.
- They arrived late at night.

KINDS OF PREPOSITIONS

1. PREPOSITIONS RELATED TO POSITION AND PLACE

These indicate position and place.

Examples

- I was born in Blantyre.
- The book is on the table.
- The cat fell into the well.
- His father is at home.
- The books are off the shelf.

2. PREPOSITIONS RELATING TO DIRECTION AND MOVEMENT

   These are prepositions associated with direction or movement from one point to another.

   Examples

   - They can run up the hill.
   - He drove through the gate.
   - They walked down the road.
   - Uwemi ran across the road.
   - She walked along the street.

3. PREPOSITIONS RELATED TO TIME

   These are prepositions associated with expressions indicating time.

   Examples

   - He was born in 1990.
   - She went home on Friday.
   - They arrived at night.
   - I haven't seen him since last month.
   - I will pay him a visit in the evening,

- I met Tadala at 10 o'clock in the morning.

Some Words or phrases with their appropriate prepositions

- To reply ***to***
- To differ ***from*** (something)
- To cope ***with***
- To complain ***about***
- To be angry ***with*** (someone)
- To be angry ***at*** (something)
- To correspond ***with*** (someone)
- To correspond ***to*** (something)
- To be familiar ***with***
- To be absent ***from***
- To suffer ***from***
- To lend ***to***
- To borrow ***from***
- To depend ***on***
- To divide ***between*** (two persons)
- To divide ***among*** (more than two persons)
- To agree ***with*** (someone)
- To agree ***at*** (what someone says or does)
- To be ashamed ***of*** (something)

7. CONJUNCTIONS

A conjunction is a word that joins words or groups of words. They are also called connecting words.

Examples

- Uwemi and Ayiweni
- Rain or snow
- Pretty but useless

KINDS OF CONJUNCTIONS

A. CO-ORDINATING CONJUNCTIONS

These are conjunctions that join words or groups of words of equal rank or class.

Examples

- Cats and dogs
- Boys and girls
- Young but strong
- Men or women

B. SUBORDINATING CONJUNCTIONS

They are conjunctions used to join subordinate clauses to main clauses.

Examples

- Although he was sick he came to school.

- Unless you work hard, you will not pass the examinations.
- She walks as if she is ill.
- We had to stand since there were no seats.
- They called him before he was ready.

C. CORRELATIVE CONJUNCTIONS

These are connecting words that are used in pairs.

The most commonly used correlative conjunctions are

- both ……. and
- either…. or
- neither …. nor
- not only …. but also

Examples

- Both Uwemi and Chisomo come from Mwazisi.
- Either Lumbani or Caroline will go with us to the party.
- Neither the President nor his ministers addressed us.
- Not only was it windy, but was also sunny.

8. INTERJECTION

It is an exclamatory word that expresses strong emotion.

An interjection has no grammatical relationship with the rest of the words in a sentence.

They are usually followed by an exclamation mark.

Examples

- Ouch! It hurts.
- Goodness! What a haircut.
- Look! The moon is full.
- Aha! I know the trick.
- Oops! I did it again.
- Hurrah! Our team has won.
- Alas! It got soaked by the rains.
- Oh! You startled me.
- Hey! That's not a good idea.

EXERCISE 1

For practice, do the following exercise

In each of the following sentences, say what part of speech is the underlined word

1. We sat quietly in our room watching television.

   A. Verb B. Adjective C. Adverb D. Conjunction

2. Lumbani became nervous after her abandoned her.

   A. Verb B. Adverb C. Preposition D. Noun

3. Many people were laughing at me.

   A. Adverb B. Noun C. Adjective D. Conjunction

4. Mr. Gondwe retired from work last year.

   A. Preposition B. Conjunction C. Adjective D. Adverb

5. I have never visited Bingu International Conference Centre.

A. Verb B. Pronoun C. Preposition D. Adverb

6. Please do me a favour.

A. Verb B. Noun C. Adverb D. Adjective

7. Madala likes playing physical games although she is old.

A. Preposition B. Pronoun C. Article D. Conjunction

8. Hurrah! That's what he deserves.

A. Conjunction B. Interjection C. Article D. Adjective

9. These are good books.

A. Pronoun B. Adjective C. Adverb D. Interjection

10. She is a teacher by profession.

A. Adjective B. Verb C. Adverb D. Noun

11. We had a long holiday due to Corona Virus pandemic.

A. Pronoun B. Article C. Adverb D. Preposition

12. Uwemi did all the household chores.

A. Conjunction B. Preposition C. Verb D. Pronoun

13. Chisomo is eating unripe oranges.

A. Verb B. Noun C. Verb D. Adjective

14. Share these sweets among those girls.

A. Preposition B. Adjective C. Adverb D. Conjunction

15. The little girl hurt herself.

A. Preposition B. Pronoun C. Conjunction D. Adverb

16. Can I see you now?

A. Verb B. Adverb Adjective D. Pronoun

17. I ate chips because my favourite food was not available.

A. Adverb B. Verb C. Pronoun D. Conjunction

18. She had a big smile on her face.

A. Verb B. Conjunction C. Noun D. Adjective

19. Oranges taste nice.

A. Adverb B. Adjective C. Noun D. Pronoun

20. Lumbani is the last born child in her family.

A. Adverb B. Adjective C. Pronoun D. Conjunction

EXERCISE 2

State what part of speech is each word in the following passage

The World of fashion is interesting. Fashions come and go and come again. For example, when I was a child I used to wear my mother's old clothes. Long dresses, pointed shoes and afro-wigs were some of the fashions that my mother used to wear. My mother was proud to show off her items. She used to tell us about how beautiful she had looked in those clothes.

(MIE, Malawi Primary Education, English Learners Book for Standard 8, Page 62)

Chapter 2

PUNCTUATION

A. END MARKS

- These are punctuation marks that appear at the end of statements.

Examples of end marks

- Full stops/periods.
- Question marks.
- Exclamation marks.

a. FULL STOP/PERIOD (.)

This punctuation mark is used in the following instances:

- At the end of the of the statement

Examples

- Tea is grown in Nkhata-Bay.
- My name is Lumbani.
- She lives in Nkhotakota.
- I have one brother and three sisters.

- In abbreviations or shortened words

Examples

- Feb. (February)
- M.P. (Member of parliament)

- Oct. (October)
- P.M. (Prime Minister)
- Dr. (Doctor)
- Ltd. (Limited)
- B.A. (Bachelor of Arts)
- Mr. (Mister)

Note: When the abbreviation of the word begins with the first letter of the word and ends with the last letter of the word, the full stop may be used or not.

Examples

- Mr. or Mr
- Dr. or Dr
- Ltd. or Ltd

b. QUESTION MARK (?)

This is a punctuation mark placed at the end of a question.

Examples

- Who has lost his book?
- What time is it?
- Where are you coming from?
- Whose car is this?
- Why did you leave my father?

c. EXCLAMATION MARK (!)

This punctuation mark is placed at the end of a statement which is an exclamation or interjection.

Examples

- What a high bridge!
- How big the moon is!
- Oops! It was so tasty.
- Hurrah! We have won.
- Wow! That's so nice.

B. THE COMMA (,)

This is a punctuation mark used to separate items in a series.

The comma may be used in the following instances:

- To separate nouns, adjectives and verbs that come together in a series.

Examples

- Uwemi is dressed in a neat, green, cotton dress.
- She bought some oranges, tomatoes, guavas and bananas.
- My bag is full of books, pencils, rulers and clothes.

- In appositives.

Examples

- The captain, Chisomo Gondwe, will not play in today's game.
- Jack, the newsboy, is late today.

- Uwemi, the secretary of our school, is in Rumphi.
- Miss Ngaunje, our English teacher, is sick.

- To separate words or phrases at the beginning or end of the sentence.

Examples

- Having missed the bus, we returned home.
- Will you please lend me your pen, Lumbani?
- Ayiweni, may I borrow your pen?
- After shouting at us, they drove away.
- Well, I think you are wrong.

C. THE APOSTROPHE (‘)

An apostrophe is a punctuation mark used in the following instances:

- To indicate possession.

Examples

- Chisomo’s book.
- Zondwayo’s house.
- Mr. Jones’ watch.
- Lumbani’s dress.
- The men’s shirt.
- The lady’s hat.

- To indicate the omission of letter (s) in words.

Examples

- Didn't-did not
- Don't-do not
- You've-you have
- I'm-I am
- Isn't-is not

- To form the plural of a letter, a figure, a symbol, or word considered as a word.

Examples

- There are two g's in my name.
- You have written three 5's.
- There are too many and's in your sentence.
- You have so many f's in your paragraph.

D. THE COLON (:)

A colon is a punctuation mark which usually signals that something is to follow.

The colon may be used in the following instances:

Before a list of items, especially after expressions like "as follows" and the "following".

Examples

- Uwemi's bag contained the following: a knife, pencils, pens and books.
- The question is as follows: find the sum of 25 and 72.
- You will need the following things for a Mathematics test: a ruler, a pencil and a protractor.

Note: a colon is never used directly after a verb or a preposition.

Examples

- My favourite games are: basketball, volleyball and soccer ***(wrong).***
- These food stuffs are made of: flour, sugar, butter and eggs ***(wrong).***

- Between the hour and the minute when you write the time.

Examples

- 8:30 A.M.
- 10:00 P.M.
- 9:04 this morning.

E. QUOTATION MAKRS (“”)

These punctuation marks are used in the following instances:

- To enclose a direct quotation (person's exact words).

Examples

- “I will go to the party”, Tadala said.
- “When the bell rings,” said the teacher, “leave the room quietly.”
- The reporter predicted, “It will be a close game.”

EXERCISE 3

For practice, answer the following

Punctuate the following sentences correctly

1. The boys books are missing.

   _____

2. What type of music do you like listening to

   _____

3. She bought mangoes oranges and guavas

   _____

4. Hey that’s not good.

   _____

5. Yankho is a standard 7 learner

   _____

6. Temwa and Chifundo are my friends said Juliet.

   _____

7. Who wrote this book

   _____

8. Oh He has fallen

   _____

9. Lumbani is her fathers favourite

_____

10. This is Mary's mother

_____

11. In which class are you

_____

12. Stop they shouted together

_____

13. My daughter Uwemi is a nurse.

_____

14. Lumbani bought the following items soap, lotion, beef and butter._____

15. Who are you waiting for _____

Chapter 3

MAKING SENTENCES

- A sentence is grammatically complete series of words consisting of a **subjec**t and **predicate**.
- A sentence gives a complete thought.

SUBJECT

- It is a grammatical word or phrase about which something is predicted.
- In active clauses with verbs denoting an action, the subject is just the same as an actor.

Examples

- **Uwemi** is an intelligent girl ("Uwemi" is the subject of the sentence).
- **They** were too slow to compete ("They" is the subject of the sentence).
- **Chisomo and Lumbani** are relatives. ("Chisomo" and "Lumbani" are the subject).
- **It** is a good idea ("It" is the subject of the sentence).
- Are **we** going to attend the party? ("We" is the subject of the sentence).

Note: The subject of a sentence can be a noun, a pronoun or a noun phrase.

PREDICATE

- It is the part of a sentence (or clause) which says something about the subject or the object of the sentence.

Examples

- Selling second hand clothes **is a good business**.
- The Headteacher **asked me to go to his office.**
- Many people **gathered under a tree shade.**
- He **has bought a new touring car.**
- Hospital workers **are supposed to be kind to patients.**
- The cyclist **rode around a sharp bend.**
- Uwemi **has a good record.**
- I **apply fertilizer in my garden frequently.**
- Women **look beautiful when they wear a wig.**
- The baby **pushed the toy away.**
- The robbers **attacked us last month.**

EXERCISE 4

For practice, answer the following:

Make sentences with each of the following words to show that you understand their meanings.

(1). persuade:

_____

(2). favourite:

_____

(3). argue:

_____

(4). faithful:

_____

(5). embarrass:

_____

(6). jeered:

_____

(7). annoyed:

_____

(8). approval:

_____

(9). sympathise:

_____

(10). wandering:

_____

(11). fault:

_____

(12). waist:

_____

(13). dusk:

_____

(14). spilled:

_____

(15). pluck:

_____

(16). apartment:

_____

(17). caretaker:

_____

(18). gathered:

_____

(19). roasted:

_____

(20). techniques:

_____

(21). prosperous:

_____

(22). emulated:

_____

(23). disappointment:

_____

(24). suddenly:

_____

(25). delicious:

_____

(26). bird:

_____

(27). vaccine:

_____

(28). abandon:

_____

(29). associated:

_____

(30). multi-coloured:

_____

(31). excited:

_____

(32). eminent:

_____

(33). occurs:

_____

(34). pretend:

_____

(35). never:

_____

(36). synthetic:

_____

(37). items:

_____

(38). scratch:

_____

(39). interrupted:

_____

(40). commotion:

_____

(41). participate:

_____

(42). collapse:

_____

(43). disembark:

_____

(44). fasten:

_____

(45). passengers:

_____

(46). bath:

_____

(47). dismissed:

_____

(49). sprinkle:

_____

(49). abstain:

_____

(50). design:

_____

Chapter 4

QUESTIO TAGS

- A question tag is a short question asked after a statement is made.

Examples

- John is rude, isn't he?
- We should have a roster, shouldn't we?
- You closed the door, didn't you?
- I am a polite learner, aren't?
- Uwemi and Lumbani are sisters, aren't they?
- She does not like shopping, does she?
- This is good news, isn't it?
- You are in standard 8, aren't you?
- We will write our examinations next year, won't we?
- My parents forced me to go to school, didn't they?
- There are not many learners in your class, are there?
- Your sister did not write examinations last year, did she?

RULES FOLLOWED WHEN CONSTRUCTING QUESTION TAGS

- **There must be a relationship between the subject used in the statement and the pronoun used in the tag.**

Examples

- **Tadala** and **Talandira** are all fine, aren't **they**? (In the statement, Tadala and Talandira are a plural subject and "they" in the question tag is a pronoun representing a plural subject).
- **Chisomo** is an intelligent boy, is **he**? (In the statement, Chisomo is a singular subject; and in the tag, pronoun "he" represents the singular subject "Chisomo").
- **We** ran to this morning**,** didn't **we? (**in the statement**, "we" is the subject in plural form; and in the tag, "we" is the pronoun in plural form).**

- **There must be a relationship regarding positivity and negativity-when the statement is in positive form, the question tag must be in negative form and vice versa**

Examples

- We ***do not*** go to school on Sunday, ***do we***?
- My mother ***doesn't*** have a car, ***does she***?
- We ***will go*** to the market next week, ***won't we***?
- This man ***doesn't*** live in our village, ***does he***?
- She ***did not*** come to school yesterday, ***did she***?

- **The tense of the verb in the statement must relate with the verb tense in the question tag**

Examples

- I **will go** to secondary school next year, **won't** I? (future).

- We **did not** close the door, **did** we? (past simple).
- They **go** to the lake every Saturday, **do** they? (present simple).
- They **have been** listening to music since morning, **haven't** they? (present perfect).
- The children **are** in the class, **aren't** they? (present simple).
- We **went** to school yesterday, **didn't** we? (past simple).

Note: words like **none**, **neither**, **hardly**, etc, usually carry a positive question tag because they are negative in form.

Examples

- None of the boys went home, **did they**?
- Neither of these is good, **isn't it**?
- We hardly know his whereabouts, **do we**?

EXERCISE 5

For practice, answer the following:

Complete each of the following statements with correct question tags

1. Hard work pays, _____?

   A. Does it B. does she C. doesn't it D. isn't it

2. We ran to school this morning, _____?

   A. Do we B. don't we C. did we D. didn't we

3. She is the tallest girl in our class, _____?

   A. Isn't she B. is she C. does she D. doesn't she

4. I am a good learner, _____?

   A. Amn't I B. am I C. aren't I D. do I

5. Lumbani has many friends, _____?

   A. Has she B. had she C. hasn't she D. hadn't she

6. He hardly works hard at school, _____?

   A. Does he B. doesn't he C. is he D. isn't he

7. You will write your final primary school examinations this year, _____?

   A. Will you B. should you C. shouldn't you D. won't you

8. This meant that I had to reach home late, _____?

   A. Do I B. hadn't I C. don't I D. did I

9. None of the boys passed the examinations, _____?

   A. Did they B. didn't they C. do they D. don't they

10. Malawi is the warm heart of Africa, _____?

    A. Is it B. does it C. isn't it D. doesn't it

11. Uwemi did not come to school yesterday, _____?

    A. Did she B. didn't she C. does she D. doesn't she

12. Goats do not speak, _____?

    A. Don't they B. did they C. didn't they D. do they

13. Nothing was said, _____?

    A. Didn't it B. isn't it C. was it D. wasn't it

14. This man does not live in our village, _____?

    A. Does she B. does he C. doesn't he D. doesn't she

15. There were no drinks at the party, _____?

    A. Were there B. weren't there C. had there D. hadn't there

Chapter 5

PROVERBS

- A proverb is a brief statement made instead of telling a long and an elaborate story.
- Proverbs are sometimes called “words of wisdom”.

Examples of proverbs

- Make hay while the sun shines.
- Experience is the best teacher.
- Time is money.
- Rome was not built in a day.
- Once beaten twice shy.
- Where there is a will, there is a way.
- A bird in the hand is worth two in the bush.
- All that glitters is not gold.
- A sleeping cat never catches a rat.
- A hungry person is an angry person.
- Too many cooks spoil the broth.
- Birds of the same feathers flock together.
- You can lead a horse to the river but you cannot force it to drink.
- An early bird catches the worm.
- What comes does not beat a drum.
- You cannot teach an old dog new tricks.

- A miss is as good as a mile.
- Time lost is never recovered or regained
- Blood is thicker than water.
- Walls have ears.
- Actions speak louder than words.
- An apple a day keeps the doctor away.
- A new broom sweeps clean.
- A stitch in time saves nine.
- One man’s meat is another man’s poison.
- Kindness recoils on the giver.
- The pot calls back the kettle.
- Generosity pays back.
- When you are in glass houses don’t throw stones.
- Don’t count your chicks before they are hatched.
- The proof of the padding is in the eating.
- One eyed man is a king among the blind.
- Strike an iron while it is still hot.
- Every dog has its day.
- Every cloud has a silver lining.
- A rolling stone gathers no moss.
- One man cannot fight a dozen.
- God tempers the wind to a shorn lamb.
- Beauty is in the hands of the beholder.

- When the cat is away mice will play.
- A friend in need is a friend indeed.
- Born with a silver spoon in the mouth.
- It never rains but it pours.

MEANINGS OF SOME OF THE PROVERBS

- Once beaten twice shy

  Bad experiences are not repeated

- Walls have ears

  There is no secret under the earth

- Blood is thicker than water

  A relative is more important than a friend

- Actions speak louder than words

  What you do counts more than what you say

- A new broom sweeps cleaner

  Do not undermine the efforts of new or young people

- A stitch in time saves nine

  Do not wait until things get out of control

- Make hay while the sun shines

  Do things when you have the chance

- All that glitters is not gold

  Do not be cheated by appearance

- One man's meat is another man's poison

  People like different things

- Birds of the same feathers flock together

  People of similar habits associate

- The early bird catches the worm

  Those who arrive early get the best choice

- Too many cooks spoil the broth

  When many people do the same work they often make a mess of it

- You cannot teach an old dog new tricks

  As people grow older they are less able to accept new ideas

- What comes does not beat a drum

  No one knows what is going to happen to him or her next

- You can lead a horse to the river but you cannot make it drink

  You can persuade people to share your views but you cannot force them to agree with you.

EXERCISE 6

For practice, answer the following questions:

In each of the following, choose the letter (A, B, C or D) that best completes the proverb

1. Birds of the same _____ flock together.

   A. family B. feathers C. blood D. group

2. Too many _____ spoil the broth.

   A. birds B. things C. people D. cooks

3. One good turn deserves _____.

   A. another B. appraisal C. punishment D. good

4. Where there is a will, there is a _____.

A. street B. path C. passage D. way

5. A ____ in the hand is worth two in the bush.

A. cock B. duck C. fowl D. bird

6. Experience is the best _____.

A. manager B. teacher C. practice D. player

7. _____ lost is never regained.

A. Time B. Energy C. Money D. Powers

8. She was born with a sliver _____ in the mouth.

A. fork B. saucer C. spoon D. cup

9. Every dog has its _____.

A. week B. day C. month D. year

10. Actions speak _____than words.

A. softer B. higher C. lower D. louder

11. You cannot teach and old ____ new tricks.

A. horse B. cat C. dog D. donkey

12. Half a loaf is better than _____.

A. fruits B. one C. cakes D. none

SIMILES

- A simile is when two unrelated things are compared in order to give a clear image of what is being said.
- It is characterised by the use of **"as"** or **"like"**.

Examples

- As black as charcoal.
- As busy as a bee.
- As angry as wasp
- As proud as peacock.
- As beautiful as a butterfly.
- As light as feathers.
- As hard as steel.
- As unchangeable as the past.
- As white as snow.
- As cold as corpse.
- As cool as cucumber.
- As meek as a dove.
- As talkative as magpie.
- As slow as a snail.
- As fast as lightening.
- As brave as a lion.
- As clever as hare.
- As dark as dusk.
- As bright as the morning star.
- As foolish as a calf.
- As cruel as death.
- As gentle as a lamb.

- As docile as a lamb
- As bald as a coot
- As big as an elephant
- As blind as a bat
- As clear as a bell/crystal
- As common as dirt.
- As free as a bird.
- As fresh as daisy
- As flat as a pancake
- As good as gold.
- As hot as hell.
- As hungry as a bear/wolf.
- As large as life.
- As mad as a hornet.
- As nutty as a fruitcake.
- As obstinate as a mule.
- As old as the hills.
- As pale as death.
- As plain as day.
- As poor as a church mouse.
- As quick as a wink/lightening/silver.
- As scarce as hen’s teeth.
- As sharp as a razor

- As sick as a dog/parrot.
- As silent as the dead/grave.
- As slippery as an eel.
- As smooth as silk.
- As sober as a judge.
- As solid as a rock.
- As wise as an owl/Solomon.
- As tough as leather.
- As tall as a giraffe.
- As dry as bone.

EXERCISE 7

For practice, answer the following:

In each of the following choose the letter (A, B, C or D) that best completes the simile

1. As _____ as the church mouse.

   A. gentle B. poor C. rich D. smart

2. As black as _____.

   A. charcoal B. coal C. kettle D. pot

3. As angry as _____.

   A. bees B. ants C. lion D wasp

4. As foolish as a _____.

   A. dog B. lamb C. calf D. hyena

5. As cool as _____.

   A. cucumber B. ginger C. onion D. yam

6. As alike as two ____ in a pod.

   A. beans B. groundnuts C. peas D. egg plants

7. As brave as _____.

   A. tiger B. lion C. elephant D. hare

8. As clever as _____.

   A. tiger B. lion C. elephant D. hare

9. As cruel as _____.

   A. death B. chief C. king D. emperor

10. As blind as a _____.

    A. Butterfly B. lamb C. bat D. rat

11. As big as _____.

    A. house B. elephant C. lion D. tiger

12. As talkative as _____.

    A. woman B. fox C. frog D. magpie

13. As proud as _____.

    A. king B. emperor C. peacock D. queen

14. As slow as a _____.

A. snail B. frog C. fish D. cock

15. As sober as a _____.

A. king B. chief C. judge D. queen

16. As quick as _____.

A. fish B. lightening C. storm D. rain

17. As flat as _____.

A. airport B. pancake C. pitch D. plateau

18. As sharp as _____.

A. razor B. knife C. spear D. machete

19. As bright as _____.

A. sun B. moon C. morning star D. planet

20. As docile as a _____.

A. lamb B. lamp C. chameleon D. cow

PHRASAL VERBS

- A phrasal verb is a combination of a verb and a preposition adverb or both.
- Phrasal verbs may sometimes have two or three parts.
- Normally, they have a hidden meaning.

PHRASAL VERBS AND THEIR MEANINGS

Break away	To go away, to give up habits
Break down	To collapse, become useless, to stop working
Break into	To enter a building by force
Break off	To stop speaking, to separate or end suddenly
Break up	To end, terminate permanently
Break out	To begin
Come about	To happen
Come across	To find by chance
Come after	To follow in pursuit
Come by	To obtain by effort
Come down	To collapse
Go along	Proceed
Go against	Oppose
Go forward	To come before
Go down	Sink, feel good/bad
Go off	To explode

Go out	To lose control of
Fall apart	To divide or decline
Fall off	To fall down
Fall through	To fail to achieve results
Keep someone under	To control/repress
Keep away from	To avoid coming near
Keep on	To continue
Keep off	To remain at a distance
Take over	To inherit/acquire
Take in	To allow to stay
Take on	To employ
Take off	To remove
Take after	To resemble or look like
Take upon oneself	To assume responsibility
Put off	To cross someone, disappoint and postpone
Put forward	Propose
Put on	The act of dressing
Put back	To put something in its original place
Put out	To extinguish
Put up	To accommodate temporarily
Put through	To make somebody under go

	through
Put someone out	Drive out
Put away	To avoid contact
Put someone in	To elect to office
Put aside	To save
Put up with	To stay with someone in trouble
Give in	To surrender
Look after	To take care of/attend
Look on	To look without taking part
Look forward	To expect something eagerly
Look down on	To despise/demean
Look up to	To copy/emulate what someone does

EXERCISE 8

For practice, answer the following questions:

In each of the following sentences choose the letter (A, B, C or D) that gives the correct meaning of the underlined phrasal verb.

1. Mary took over her father's house last year.

   A. sold B. bought C. acquired D. rented

2. The identical twins have taken after their grandfather.

   A. resembled B. stolen C. differed D. stayed with

3. The bus broke down on its way to Blantyre.

A. Stopped working B. became operational C. became functional D. crushed

4. They <u>went back</u> to school after a long holiday.

   A. returned B. retreated C. surrendered D. never returned

5. Lumbani may <u>drop out</u> of school if teachers are not kind to her.

   A. start B. return C. withdraw D. establish

6. The school is <u>looking into</u> learners' absenteeism.

   A. advising B. examining C. assisting D. exploring

7. Yesterday, I <u>came across</u> my stolen cell phone.

   A. Met B. dismissed C. missed D. found

8. The doctor advised him to <u>cut down</u> on fatty foods.

   A. eat more B. eat enough C. reduce D. stop taking

9. The church is <u>looking after</u> the orphans.

   A. taking care of B. demeaning C. hating D. reducing

10. After resisting arrest, the thieves finally <u>gave in.</u>

    A. handed B. surrendered C. restricted D. retreated

11. some learners <u>look down upon</u> their friends in class.

    A. Care for B. demean C. slap D. flog

12. The bomb <u>went off</u> with a loud noise.

    A. extinguished B. exploded C. produced D. kept

13. At our school, we <u>knock off</u> at 2:30 pm.

    A. Start learning B. continue learning C. hit on the door D. stop learning

14. I sold the bag at a <u>give away</u> price.

A. High B. low B. good D. profitable

15. The fire brigade assisted us to <u>put out</u> the fire.

A. start B. extinguish C. rekindle D. none

Chapter 6

COMPREHENSION

- Comprehension is a kind of test aimed at finding out if the reader has understood a given text or passage through answering questions.

TYPES OF COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

1. Observation questions

- These test the critical thinking of the reader.

Examples

- Why was the monster feared?
- Why did the writer's parents escort him to school?
- Why did the company organize the competition?

2. Comparison questions

    - These questions help to establish if the reader is able to notice differences or similarities between two items or facts.
    - If the reader has fully understood the passage, they are able to compare:
        - ✓ Actual words used
        - ✓ Writer's vocabulary or words
        - ✓ The way words have been used
        - ✓ Facts and questions asked in the text

Examples

- Give the meanings of each of the following words as used in the passage:

(i) Preserve _____

(ii) Admire _____

- Pick a word from paragraph 2 which is similar in meaning to the word "excite

3. Reflection questions

   These types of questions stir the critical thinking of the reader.

   They relate the passage to the mind of the writer.

Examples

- What made Lumbani think that the place was dangerous?
- Briefly describe Lumbani's behavior.

4. Selection questions

   These are questions that test the reader to see if they are able to select or choose suitable items from close reading and observations.

   Examples

   - Mention any two animals in the story
   - How many festivals did Uwemi attend?

GENERAL RULES IN ANSWERING COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

- Be as brief as possible. You have to go direct to the answer.
- Use your own words as much as possible.

- Punctuate your answers properly.
- Do not lift word for word as part of your answer.

SAMPLE TEXT AND ITS MODEL ANSWERS

As early as seven o'clock in the morning, lorries had already started ferrying participants to our school. Each school was identified by its uniform. By nine o'clock, everything was set. The District Education Manager, who was the Guest of Honour, headteachers and other dignitaries arrived in time. The Traditional Authority also accompanied the guest of honour. Indeed, it was a big day. His presence added pomp to the occasion. The games commenced. ***(MIE, Malawi Primary Education, English Learners book for standard 8, page 89).***

Questions

(a). How was each school identified on this particular day?

✓ It was identified ***by its uniform***.

(b). Mention any **two** dignitaries that were present at this function.

✓ These are ***the District Education Manager*** and the ***Headteachers***.

(c). Give the meanings of each of the following words as used in the passage.

(i). ferrying- it means ***carrying.***

(ii). Accompanied-it means ***escorted.***

(d). Suggest a title for the passage

✓ ***The sports festival.***

(e). At what time did the preparation for this day start?

✓ ***Seven o'clock in the morning.***

EXERCISE 9

For practice, answer the following:

Read the passage below carefully and answer the questions that follow

Kaleza village is near Mperere river. People in this village are farmers. They grow vegetables and maize on both sides of the river. They also do some fishing.

One day, two children from Kaleza village, Durani and Sanzira, removed the road sign post which indicated a bridge ahead. They also removed the rails and iron sheets which protected the bridge from being eroded. The bridge became weak and was washed away by rainy water. One night, Umodzi's uncle felt sick and people in Kaleza called for an ambulance. The ambulance driver did not know that he was approaching the bridge, and worse still, that part of the bridge had been washed away. Suddenly, the ambulance fell into the river. Although the driver survived, the ambulance was badly damaged.

Questions

1. Where is Kaleza village located_____ (1 mark)
2. Mention **two** things on which the people of Kaleza village depend to earn a living.

   _____ _____ (2 marks)
3. Besides the sign post, what other **two** materials were removed from the bridge?

   _____ _____ (2 marks)
4. Who removed the sign post which indicated a bridge ahead?
   _____ _____ (2 marks)

5. Give the meanings of each of the following words as used in the passage:

   (i) eroded **(Paragraph 2)** _____ (2 marks)

   (ii) approaching **(Paragraph 2)** _____ (2 marks)

6. Why did the people from Kaleza call for an ambulance?

   _____ (2 marks)

7. What could be the title of the passage?

   _____ (2 marks)

Chapter 7

CLAUSES

- A clause is a group of words that contains a finite verb.
- A finite verb is the verb that agrees with the subject in a sentence.

Examples

- He goes to school every day (the verb “goes” agrees with the subject “he”)
- They go to school every day (the verb “go” agrees with the subject “they”)

KINDS OF CLAUSES

These are noun clauses, adjective clauses and adverb clauses

1. NOUN CLAUSES

- A noun clause is a subordinate clause that is used as a noun.

FUNCTIONS OF NOUN CLAUSES

Noun clauses perform different functions as follow:

A. Noun clause as object of the verb

Examples

- He said <u>he would go</u>. (object of the verb “said”)
- I think <u>that he has already left the office</u>. (object of the verb “think”)
- I heard <u>what he said</u>. (object of the verb “said”)
- Uwemi does <u>whatever she likes</u>. (object of the verb “does”)

- I cannot understand how that mistake was made. (object of the verb “cannot understand”)

B. Noun clause as subject of the verb

Examples

- What she said was true. (subject of the verb “said”)
- What he did surprised us. (subject of the verb “surprised”)
- Why I do this is completely reasonable. (subject of the verb “is”)
- Whoever does this job will be rewarded. (subject of the verb “will be rewarded”)
- Whether we eat or not depends on the food we have. (subject of the verb “depends”)
- What we expected proved futile. (subject of the verb “proved”)

C. Noun clause as object of the preposition

Examples

- Give the prize to whoever scores the most points. (object of preposition “to”)
- We cannot depend on what she says. (object of preposition “on”)
- The land was sold for what it was worth. (object of preposition “for”)
- Give it to whoever wants it. (object of preposition “to”)

D. Noun clause as complement of the verb

Examples

- This is <u>what I wanted</u>. (complement of the verb “is”)
- The winner will be <u>whichever player scores the most points</u>. (complement of the verb “will be”)
- This appears to be <u>what they were expecting</u>. (complement of the verb “appears to be”)

E. Noun clause in apposition to another noun

Examples

- The rumour <u>that he stole some oranges</u> was false. (in apposition to noun “rumour”)
- The fact <u>that he is fat</u> gives him satisfaction. (in apposition to noun “fact”)
- The report <u>that the team had lost</u> was true. (in apposition to noun “report”)
- The news <u>that the plane had crushed</u> shocked everyone. (in apposition to noun “news”)
- The knowledge <u>that he was right</u> proved his depth of thinking. (in apposition to noun “knowledge”)

2. ADJECTIVE CLAUSE

- It is a group of words which includes a finite verb and does the work of an adjective.

- An adjective qualifies a noun or a pronoun, which is called an antecedent.
- An adjective clause is normally introduced by relative pronouns such as ***"who", "whose", "whom", "which", "that"***

Examples

- The woman **who is there** is my aunt **(qualifies noun "woman").**
- The police questioned the man **whom they suspected to be a thief** **(qualifies noun "man").**
- The house **which I built** has been blown off by strong winds **(qualifies noun "house").**
- The girl **who stole some oranges** is that one **(qualifies noun "girl").**
- The car **that I bought** had been stolen **(qualifies noun "car").**
- This is the season **when we enjoy at the lake** **(qualifies noun "season").**
- The boy **who found the lost luggage** is my brother **(qualifies noun "boy").**

DEFINING OR RESTRICTIVE ADJECTIVE CLAUSES

- A restrictive adjective clause is the one that tells us exactly who or what the noun is.
- It restricts the meaning of the antecedent.

Examples

- The woman **who is here** is my sister**.**

- The teacher **who taught us last year** has retired.
- I don't like children **who eat sweets.**
- This is the boat **which sailed on the lake.**
- The book **which you lost** is not mine.

NON-RESTRICTIVE ADJECTIVE CLAUSES

- Non-restrictive adjective clause is the one that is not essential to the word it qualifies.
- It merely gives information about the antecedent and is separated by commas from the main clause.

Examples

- Mr. Gondwe, **who is in the house,** is a teacher.
- My aunt, **who works in Rumphi district**, has come to pay us a visit.
- My father, **who is now old**, is still energetic.

3. ADVERB CLAUSES

- An adverb clause is a subordinate clause that does the work of an adverb.
- Adverb clauses are introduced by subordinating conjunctions like ***"when", "where", "while", "before", "as", "unless", "because", "although***", etc.
- Adverb clauses modify ***verbs, adjectives*** and other ***adverbs*** in the main clause.

Examples

- The vehicle arrived **as the sun was rising** **(modifies the verb "arrived").**
- He will come **when you call him** **(modifies the verb "will come")**
- She dances **as if she is hysteric** **(modifies the verb "dances").**
- **Although I was sick** I went to school **(modifies the verb "went").**
- They arrived earlier **than I expected** **(modifies adverb "earlier").**

KINDS OF ADVERB CLAUSES

A. ADVERB CLAUSES OF TIME

- These indicate when something happened.

Examples

- **When I met her** it was late in the afternoon **(modifies the verb "was").**
- She slept **while I was working** **(modifies the verb "slept").**
- The bus arrived **as the sun was setting** **(modifies the verb "arrived").**
- **When I arrived** they started shouting at me **(modifies the verb "started shouting".**

B. ADVERB CLAUSES OF PLACE

- They show where something happened.

Examples

- The man lay **where he had fallen** **(modifies the verb "lay").**
- I found the suit **where I put it** **(modifies the verb "found").**
- They are sleeping **where I slept** **(modifies the verb "are sleeping").**
- They planted trees **where they were safe** **(modifies the verb "planted").**

C. ADVERB CLAUSES OF MANNER

- The indicate how something is done.

Examples

- He walks **as if he is ill** **(modifies the verb "walks").**
- You must do this **as I do** **(modifies the verb "must do")**
- He acted **as if he was a king** **(modifies the verb "acted").**
- She speaks **as if she has a cold** **(modifies the verb "speaks").**

D. ADVERB CLAUSES OF REASON OR CAUSE

- They express why something was done.

Examples

- They opened the windows **because it was hot** **(modifies the verb "opened").**

- We missed the bus **because we were late** **(modifies the verb "missed").**
- **Since there were no seats** we had to stand **(modifies the verb "had to stand").**

E. ADVERB CLAUSES OF RESULT

- They show the result of an action or situation.

Examples

- It was so cold **that we took our warm clothes** **(modifies adjective "cold").**
- She acted so well **that she was given a prize** **(modifies adverb "well")**
- He was so intelligent **that he got full marks** **(modifies adjective "intelligent")**
- He woke up so early **that we hardly saw him** **(modifies adverb "early").**

F. ADVERB CLAUSES OF CONDITION

- They give conditions under which something can be done.

Examples

- **If you need me** you will call me **(modifies the verb "will call**").
- **If I see him** I will warn him **(modifies the verb "will warn").**
- **Should the rains fall** we shall not go **(modifies the verb "shall not go").**
- **If you need my help** do not hesitate to call me **(modifies the verb "do not hesitate to call).**

G. ADVERB CLAUSES OF CONCESSION

- They are introduced by ***"though"*** or ***"although".***

Examples

- **Though I was late** I came to class **(modifies the verb "came").**
- **Although he is rich** he doesn't show off **(modifies the verb "doesn't show off").**
- **Although he shouted at me I** answered him kindly **(modifies the verb "answered").**
- She participated in the race **although she had a cold (modifies the verb "participated").**

H. ADVERB CLAUSES OF PURPOSE

- The indicate the aim for doing something.

Examples

- We are working hard **so that we may succeed (modifies the verb "are working").**
- I called you **so that we may discuss the matter fully (modifies the verb "called").**
- She trained as a teacher **so that she should teach English in Malawi (modifies the verb "trained").**
- I have bought this car **so that I visit my parents regularly (modifies the verb "have bought").**

I. ADVERB CLAUSES OF COMPARISON OR DEGREE

- They compare or indicate the extent to which something is done.

Examples

- She likes oranges more <u>than I do</u> **(modifies adjective "more").**
- Uwemi is playing better <u>than she did last year</u> **(modifies adjective "better").**
- My brother is shorter <u>than I am</u> **(modifies adjective "shorter").**
- Chisomo is as old <u>as I am</u> **(modifies adjective "old").**
- She arrived sooner <u>than we expected</u> **(modifies adjective "sooner").**

EXERCISE 10

For practice, answer the following:

Identify the type of the underlined clause and state its function

1. I will follow <u>wherever he goes.</u>

   A. Adverb clause, modifies the verb "goes"

   B. Noun clause, object of the verb "goes"

   C. Noun clause, object of the verb "will follow"

   D. Adjective clause, qualifies pronoun "he"

2. Uwemi is sure <u>that she will pass her examinations</u>.

   A. Adjective clause, qualifies noun "Uwemi"

   B. Noun clause, in apposition to noun "Uwemi"

   C. Adverb clause, modifies the verb "is"

   D. Noun clause, complement of the verb "is"

3. This is the land <u>which he bought</u>.

   A. Noun clause, subject of the verb “is”

   B. Adjective clause, qualifies noun “land”

   C. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “is”

   D. Noun clause, complement of the verb “is”

4. The fact <u>that Chisomo is an intelligent boy</u> pleases his parents.

   A. Adjective clause, qualifies noun “fact”

   B. Noun clause, in apposition to noun “fact”

   C. Noun clause, in apposition to noun “Chisomo”

   D. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “pleases”

5. I will go home <u>after I have done the assignment.</u>

   A. Noun clause, object of the verb “will go”

   B. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “will go”

   C. Adjective clause, qualifies noun “home”

   D. Noun clause, subject of the verb “will go”

6. This is <u>what I want you to do.</u>

   A. Noun clause, complement of the verb “is”

   B. Noun clause, object of preposition “to”

   C. Noun clause, object of the verb “is”

   D. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “is”

7. The woman <u>who is in a red dress</u> is my mother.

   A. Noun clause, in apposition to noun “woman”

   B. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “is”

C. Noun clause, subject of the verb “is”

D. Adjective clause, qualifies noun “woman”

8. <u>If you don’t work hard,</u> you will not pass the examinations.

A. Noun clause, subject of the verb “will not pass”

B. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “will not pass”

C. Adjective clause, qualifies noun “examinations”

D. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “don’t work”

9. <u>What he says</u> is useless.

A. Noun clause, object of the verb “is”

B. Noun clause, complement of the verb “is”

C. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “is”

D. Noun clause, subject of the verb “is”

10. <u>Unless you work hard</u>, you will not succeed in life.

A. Noun clause, subject of the verb “will not succeed”

B. Adjective clause, qualifies noun “life”

C. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “will not succeed”

D. Noun clause, complement of the verb “will not succeed”

11. Lumbani is doing better <u>than she did last year</u>.

A. Noun clause, object of the verb “is doing”

B. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “is doing”

C. Adverb clause, modifies adjective “better”

D. Adjective clause, qualifies noun “Lumbani”

12. Many people are wearing sweaters today <u>because it is cold.</u>

A. Noun clause, object of the verb “are wearing”

B. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “are wearing”

C. Adjective clause, qualifies noun “sweaters”

D. Noun clause, subject of the verb “are wearing”

13. The girl is listening to <u>what you are saying.</u>

A. Noun clause, object of preposition “to”

B. Noun clause, object of the verb “is listening”

C. Adjective clause, qualifies noun “girl”

D. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “is listening”

14. The teacher <u>who teaches us English</u> is Mr. Gondwe.

A. Noun clause, in apposition to noun “teacher”

B. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “is”

C. Adjective clause, qualifies noun “teacher”

D. Noun clause, object of the verb “is”

15. It seems <u>that she has never done it before</u>.

A. Noun clause, complement of the verb “seems”

B. Adverb clause, modifies the verb “seems”

C. Noun clause, subject of the verb “seems”

D. Adjective clause, qualifies pronoun “it”

CONDITIONAL SENTENCES

- A conditional sentence is a sentence that discusses factual implications or hypothetical situations and their consequences.
- The full conditional sentence contains two clauses which are the ***condition*** and the ***consequence***.

KINDS OF CONDITIONAL SENTENCES

A. OPEN CONDITIONAL

- Open conditional sentences are usually of the following pattern:

(i). main clause (future tense) + subordinate adverbial clause (if + present tense)

Examples

- Uwemi will learn English if she goes to school.
- I will pay him a visit if it all goes well.
- They will go to the party if you go with them.
- Chisomo will visit Golden Peacock hotel if he goes to Lilongwe.
- Lumbani will write her mother if she remembers.

(ii). Subordinate adverbial clause of condition (if + present tense) + main clause (future tense)

Examples

- If Tamanda goes to the party, she will dance.
- If Lumbani rings the bell, she will remind other learners of entering the class.

- If they go to Lilongwe, they will see the Parliament building.
- If Tadala goes to England, she will learn English language.
- If we go to the lake, we will buy fish.

B. UNLIKELY CONDITIONAL

- Unlikely conditional sentences are usually of the following patterns:

(i). main clause (would/should + stem) + subordinate adverbial clause of condition (if + simple past tense)

Examples

- She would pay you a visit if she had time.
- Lumbani would learn English if she went to school.
- He would come if you called him.
- I would kill the snake if I saw it.
- They would watch the game if they went to the pitch.

(ii). Subordinate adverbial clause (if + past tense) + main clause (would/should + stem)

Examples

- If I saw the lion, I would kill it.
- If they went home in time, they would find him.
- If Uwemi went to class, she would not miss the paper.
- If you called her, she would come.
- If she went to the party, she would enjoy the food.

C. UNFULFILLED CONDITIONAL

- Unfulfilled conditional sentences are usually of the following patterns:

(i). main clause (would/should + have + past participle) + subordinate adverbial clause of condition (if + past perfect tense)

Examples

- She would have become a nurse if she had gone to a nursing college.
- Lumbani would have met you if she had come.
- You would have seen Capital Hill if you had gone to Lilongwe.
- Chisomo would have killed a snake if he had seen it.
- Takondwa would have gone to the party if she had not been ill.

(ii). Subordinate adverbial clause of condition (if + past perfect tense) + main clause (would/should + have + past participle)

Examples

- If Mayingiso had seen Tadala, he would have been happy.
- If Chembekezo had come to the wedding, he would have seen his sister.
- If I had had enough money, I would have bought a new car.
- If Uwemi had gone to the party, she would have enjoyed the food.

EXERCISE 11

For practice, answer the following:

Choose the letter (A, B, C or D) that represents the correct answer in each of the following sentences.

1. Takondwe will visit her aunt if she _____ to Rumphi.

   A. goes B. will go C. would go D. should go

2. I would have gone for shopping if I _____ money.

   A. have B. had C. would have D. will have

3. If they _____ him, he would come.

   A. had invited B. have invited C. invited D. had had invited

4. Chisomo would learn English if he ____ to England.

   A. goes B. had gone C. had had gone D. went

5. Uwemi will write to her mother if she _____.

   A. will remember B. had remembered C. will have remembered D. remembers

6. I would kill the rat if I ___ it.

   A. will see B. would see C. saw D. will have seen

7. If I had seen him I _____ happy.

   A. Would be B. would have been C. will have been D. had been

8. If she went home in time, she ____ meet him.

   A. would B. would have C. will D. will have

9. If I go to the party, I ___ dance.

   A. would B. will C. will have D. would have

10. She would pay you a visit if she ____ time.

   A. had B. would have C. had had D. will have

Chapter 8

DIRECT AND INDIRECT SPEECH

DIRECT SPEECH

- These are the actual words spoken by someone and are quoted within inverted commas or quotation marks.

Examples

- Uwemi said, “I am going home”.
- “How far is it from here?”, he asked.
- “If he comes early”, Chisomo said “He will catch the bus”

POINTS TO NOTE

- Only words actually spoken are placed within inverted commas.
- A comma is placed just before or after the actual words.
- The actual words should begin with a capital letter.
- When a direct quotation is broken into two parts, it should be separated by a comma.
- Punctuation mark at the end of the statement is within inverted commas.

INDIRECT SPEECH

- This is when a speech has been reported by a person who heard it.

Examples

- Uwemi said that she was going home.
- He wanted to know how far it was from there.
- The referee declared that the match would start at 2:30 pm

POINTS TO NOTE

- Indirect speeches begin with an introductory clause and a conjunction.
- The statement in indirect speech does not have inverted commas.

Examples of introductory clauses

- He said that
- He reported that
- He stated that
- He announced that
- He declared that
- She admitted that
- She explained that

- When the sentence changed from direct to indirect speech, the tense of the verb in the introductory clause controls the tense of the verbs in other clauses.

Examples

Direct: "I am washing my shirt"

Indirect: He says he is washing his shirt.

He has just said that he is washing his shirt.

He said that he was washing his shirt.

Direct: “I wrote a letter”

Indirect: He said that he had written a letter.

He says that he wrote a letter.

CHANGES IN VERBS

Shall, will--------should, would

Has, have---------had

Can----------could

May----------might

Was, were---------had been

Are---------were

Is----------was

CHANGES IN ADJECTIVES AND ADVERBS

This----------that

These---------those

Here----------there

Now----------then

Today----------that day

Tomorrow--------the next day/the following day

Ago----------before

Last night-------the night before/the previous night

Yesterday--------previous day/the day before

PRONOUNS AND POSSESSIVE ADJECTIVES

- All pronouns and possessive adjectives should be in third person if in reported speech.

Examples

Direct: “I have lost my book”, Uwemi said.

Indirect: Uwemi said that she had lost her book

Direct: “We are glad that we have come”, he said.

Indirect: He said that they were glad that they had come.

- If the speech is reported by a person to whom it was addressed, the first person is used in place of the second person.

Examples

Direct: “You have missed your bus”

Indirect: He said that I had missed my bus.

Direct:” You have had your last chance”

Indirect: He said that I had had my last chance.

Direct: “Your bag is in your room”

Indirect: He said that my bag is in my room.

ADJECTIVES AND ADVERBS

- Adjectives and adverbs in direct statement denoting nearness in time or place are changed to adjectives and adverbs denoting remoteness when the reporting verb is in the past tense.

Examples

Direct: "You will have this book tomorrow"

Indirect: He said that I would have that book the following day.

Direct: "You will find me here tomorrow"

Indirect: She said that I would find her there the next day.

Direct: "This boy came to see me yesterday"

Indirect: He said that that boy came to see him the day before.

EXERCISE 12

For practice, answer the following:

Change the following sentences from direct to indirect speech

1. **Direct:** "We produce many crops in this area," he said.

   Indirect: _____

2. **Direct**: "We had a lot of promises but no development," Lumbani said.

   Indirect: _____

3. **Direct:** "Don't leave the room," she said.

   Indirect: _____

4. **Direct:** "Thangata system is bad," he said.

Indirect: _____

5. **Direct:** “My mother works in the bank,” Uwemi said.

Indirect: _____

6. **Direct:** “I came to see you last night,” Tadala said.

Indirect: _____

7. **Direct:** “May I return the book tomorrow,” he said.

Indirect: _____

8. **Direct:** “I will come tomorrow,” John said.

Indirect: _____

9. **Direct:** “Mary went to the hospital yesterday,” her mother said.

Indirect: _____

10. **Direct:** “Do not drink and drive,” a police officer warned our minibus driver

Indirect: _____

11. **Direct:** “There is a holiday tomorrow,” the headteacher announced.

Indirect: _____

12. **Direct:** “My father goes to work every day,” I said to the visitor.

Indirect: _____

13. **Direct:** “I have a feeling that you will win the game,” Jane said.

Indirect: _____

14. **Direct:** “Do you admit the charges levelled against you in this court?” The judge asked Landani.

Indirect: _____

15. **Direct:** “Stop what you are doing!” Chisomo commanded us.

Indirect: _____

16. **Direct:** “Would you please come here,” she said.

    Indirect: _____

17. **Direct:** “Go and arrest them,” the officer In-charge told us.

    Indirect: _____

18. **Direct:** “My name is Lumbani,” She said.

    Indirect: _____

19. **Direct:** “would you leave me alone,” he said.

    Indirect: _____

20. **Direct:** “Would you borrow us some money,” he said.

    Indirect: _____

ACTIVE AND PASSIVE VOICES

- Voice is a grammatical term that shows the doer and the receiver of the action of the verb.
- A sentence can be changed from one voice to another, i.e, from active to passive voice.

ACTIVE VOICE

- A sentence is in active voice when the subject is the doer of the action.

Examples

- The cat killed a rat.
- The snake ate the chicks.
- The boy climbed a hill.
- Mr. Gondwe teaches us English.

PASSIVE VOICE

- The sentence is in passive voice when the subject becomes the receiver of the action.

Examples

- The rat was killed by the cat.
- The chicks were eaten by the snake.
- A hill is climbed by the boy.
- English is taught by Mr. Gondwe.

POINTS TO NOTE WHEN CHANGING A SENTENCE FROM ACTIVE TO PASSIVE VOICE

A. The object of the active voice verb becomes the subject of the passive verb.

Example

Active voice: Tasokwa kicked the ball.

Passive voice: The ball was kicked by Tasokwa

B. The subject of the verb becomes the object of “by” (agent)

Example

Active voice: Mr. Gondwe teaches English.

Passive voice: English is taught by Mr. Gondwe.

C. If the doer in active voice is not specified, the passive voice omits the prepositional phrase (by+object).

Example

Active voice: Someone likes bananas.

Passive voice: Bananas are liked.

D. The form of the verb is changed using the same tense of the verb “to be” with the past participle verb.

Examples

ACTIVE VOICE	PASSIVE VOICE
A. SIMPLE PRESENT TENSE	

1. Mr. Gondwe teaches English	English is taught by Mr. Gondwe.
2. The children eat the food	The food is eaten by the children.
B. PRESENT CONTINUOUS TENSE 1. The teacher is teaching English	English is being taught by the teacher
2. The doctor is treating the patient	The patient is being treated by the doctor
3. Is Uwemi washing the plates?	Are plates being washed by Uwemi?
C. SIMPLE PAST TENSE 1. Chisomo called them	They were called by Chisomo
2. Did Portia eat the apple?	Was the apple eaten by Portia?
D. PAST CONTINUOUS TENSE 1. Uwemi was escorting Chisomo	Chisomo was being escorted by Uwemi
2. Were all the learners writing the test?	Was the test being written by all learners?
E. PAST PERFECT TENSE 1. Lucy has passed the examinations	The examinations had been passed by Lucy
2. Had Lumbani eaten the	Had the oranges been eaten

oranges?	by Lumbani?
F. SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE 1. He will write the letters	The letters will be written by him
2. Will the driver pick her up at 10 am?	Will she be picked by the driver at 10 am?
G. FUTURE PERFECT TENSE 1. She will have taught the class	The class will have been taught by her
2. Will Lumbani have eaten the porridge?	Will the porridge have been eaten by Lumbani?

EXERCISE 13

For practice, answer the following:

Change the following sentences from active to passive voice

1. **Active**: Our school hosted the sports festival.

   Passive: _____

2. **Active**: The Headteacher will open the function.

   Passive: _____

3. **Active**: The Traditional Authority accompanied the guest of honour.

   Passive: _____

4. **Active**: Uwemi ate the oranges.

   Passive: _____

5. **Active**: The director gave prizes to the winners.

   Passive: _____

6. **Active:** He was watching football.

   Passive: _____

7. **Active**: Supporters cheered for the teams.

   Passive: _____

8. **Active:** Did the teacher teach the subject?

   Passive: _____

9. **Active:** The committee elected Uwemi as their secretary.

   Passive: _____

10. **Active:** He will have taught English by 8 am

    Passive: _____

11. **Active:** They had seen the president.

    Passive: _____

12. **Active**: We are washing the clothes.

    Passive: _____

13. **Active:** She has inherited my house.

    Passive: _____

14. **Active**: The court had declared the law unconstitutional.

    Passive: _____

15. **Active**: Our school won the trophy.

    Passive: _____

Chapter 9

COMPOSITION

- Composition writing is one of the important parts examined during Primary School Leaving Certificate English paper.
- Unlike, a letter, report and speech, a composition has fewer features or components.

FEATURES OF A COMPOSITION

The composition has the following components: **title, introduction, body** and **conclusion**.

1. **TITLE**
    - Every composition should have a title.
    - It should be short and positioned in the centre.
    - The title can be written in **two** different ways as follows:

      (i). in capital letters and not underlined.

      (ii). In small letters and underlined.

Note: when the title is written in small letters, only the first letter of the first word should be capitalised.

2. **INTRODUCTION**
    - It gives the overview of what is going to be said in the body.
    - It is part of the first paragraph.
3. **DEVELOPMENT**
    - At primary level, this follows the guidelines or guiding questions that are given.

- Usually, the development is written in three paragraphs.

4. **CONCLUSION**

- This brings the composition to an end.
- It is part of paragraph three.

A SAMPLE QUESTION AND ITS MODEL ANSWER

Imagine you had an interesting school trip to a game reserve. Write a composition entitled **"An unforgettable trip to a game reserve"**

In your composition include the following:

Paragraph 1

- Who organized the trip
- When the trip took place
- Who you went there with
- Why the trip was made

Paragraph 2

- How you travelled to the game reserve
- Who welcomed you at the game reserve
- **Three** interesting things you saw at the game reserve

Paragraph 3

- **Two** lessons you learnt from the trip
- Why the trip is unforgettable

MODEL ANSWER

UNFORGETTABE TRIP TO A GAME RESERVE

I want to tell you about the unforgettable trip to a game reserve which our school had. The trip was organized by our matron, Mr. Zayenda. The trip took place on 13th July, 2021. Amongst those who went with me were the wildlife club members of our school. The trip was made because our patron wanted us to see different animals and natural trees.

We travelled to the game reserve by bus which our school had hired from National Bus Company. At the game reserve, we were welcomed by Mrs. Ndiche, the manageress of the game reserve. Three things which I saw at the game reserve were animals like elephants and zebras, trees and a waterfall which had beautiful waters.

We learnt a lot of lessons from the trip and two of these were that it is good to care for wild animals and trees, and that wild animals and other creatures attract tourists. The trip is unforgettable because it was my first time to visit the game reserve. This is all I wanted to tell about the trip.

EXERCISE 14

For practice, answer the following:

(i). Write a composition on how to preserve maize. You may include the following points:

Paragraph 1

- When maize should be harvested
- How maize is harvested

Paragraph 2

- How maize is processed before it is preserved

Paragraph 3

- How maize is preserved
- Why maize is preserved

(MIE, Malawi Primary Education, English Learners' book for Standard 8)

(ii). Imagine that one day you delayed for classes. You, therefore, found that your classmates had already started lessons. Write a composition entitled **"The delay"**

In your composition include the following points:

Paragraph 1

- What activities you planned to do on that day
- The time you planned to spend on each activity
- The time you actually spent on each activity

Paragraph 2

- What caused the delay for the classes
- What **two** things happened to you because of the delay

Paragraph 3

- **Two** things you will do in future to avoid another delay

(MANEB, 2017, PSLCE English Paper, Page 2; English Learners book for Standard 7, Page 104)

(iii). Write a composition on the topic **"My holiday plans".**

Include the following information:

Paragraph 1

- When are you going on holiday?
- Where are you going to spend your holiday?
- With whom are you going?

Paragraph 2

- Why do you want to go there?
- Explain other things you want to do there.

Paragraph 3

- What type of transport are you going to use?
- State reasons why you have chosen that type of transport.

(Mchengawedi Zone, 2015, English Mock Examination Paper, Page 2)

(iv). Write a composition about life in town. The title of your composition should be **"Life in town"**. You may include the following points:

Paragraph 1

- When you went to town
- Why you went to town
- Who you went there with
- Who you visited

Paragraph 2

- What things you liked in town

- What things you disliked

Paragraph 3

- Whether you would like to go back to town or not

(MIE, Malawi Primary Education, English Learners' book for Standard 6, Page 35)

(v). Write a composition on the topic "A job I want to do". Use the following questions to guide you.

Paragraph 1

- What job do you want to do when you finish school?
- Why do want this job?
- When did you start admiring this job?

Paragraph 2

- Who in your area has a similar job?
- What interesting things does he/she do which make you admire the job?

Paragraph 3

- What do you need to do now for you to get this job?
- What encouragement do you get from your parents and relatives?

LETTER WRITING

- Letter writing is one of the important questions frequently examined at Primary School Leaving Certificate examinations.
- There are two types of letters. These are **friendly** and **business** letters.

1. FRIENDLY LETTER

This type of letter is addressed to a friend or the person you know.

FEATURES OF A FRIENDLY LETTER

- ✓ It has one address and a date.
- ✓ It has a salutation.
- ✓ It has an introduction.
- ✓ It has a body or development.
- ✓ It has a conclusion.
- ✓ It has an ending or valediction.

(a). ADDRESS AND A DATE

- A friendly letter comprises only one address which indicates where the letter is coming from.
- The address is written on upper the right corner of the page.
- The date is written one line down the address.
- The date must be written in “dd mm, yyyy” format, eg, 17th May, 2021.

There are two different ways of writing the address, which are **the block type** and the **indented type.** In this case, we are going to consider the block

type which is also recommended at primary school leaving certificate examinations.

Example of a block type address and a date

Waliro Primary School
Post Office Box 38
Kamphenda
Rumphi.

17th May, 2021.

Note: There is a comma between the date and the year to separate the two.

(b). SALUTATION

- On the salutation of a friendly letter, the name of the person to whom the letter is addressed is specifically indicated.
- The salutation starts from the margin.
- The comma must be put after the name.

Example

Dear Lumbani,

(c). INTRODUCTION

- The introduction usually gives an overview of what is going to explained in the body or development of the letter.
- At Primary School Leaving Certificate examinations, the introduction is usually attached to the first paragraph of the body paragraphs.
- It must be written from the margin.

- It must be written in relation to a given theme.

Example of an introduction of a friendly letter

I would like to tell you more about my new school.

(d). BODY OR DEVELOPMENT

- This is where the details of the letter are explained.
- At primary school leaving certificate level, the explanation is based on the guidelines or guiding questions that are given.
- The body should have three paragraphs.
- Skip a line before writing another paragraph.

(e). CONCLUSION

- This is where you put your letter to a wrap-up or closing.
- The conclusion is usually attached to the last paragraph of the body or development.
- This can be done in different ways, for example, by greeting friends or members of a family through a friend to whom the letter is addressed.

(f). ENDING OR VALEDICTION

- This is the very end where you indicate your name.
- In a friendly letter, in the ending or valediction, is indicated only your first name because the letter is addressed to a person who knows you already.

Example

Yours,

Uwemi.

SAMPLE QUESTION AND ITS MODEL ANSWER

Write a letter your friend advising him or her on the things he or she needs to do in life and those he or she should not do. Use the following notes:

Paragraph 1

- Find out how your friend is and what he/she is doing.
- Tell your friend where you are and what you are doing.

Paragraph 2

- Tell your friend of your success in life.
- Tell your friend what he/she needs to do for him/her to succeed.

Paragraph 3

- Advise your friend on the things he/she need not to do to succeed.
- Invite your friend to come and see you at your place.

(MIE, Malawi Primary School, English Learners' book for Standard 6, Page 48)

MODEL ANSWER

Waliro Primary School
Post Office Box 38
Kamphenda
Rumphi.

18th May, 2021.

Dear Mayingiso,

I write this letter to you to advise you on the things you need to and those

you need not to do in order to succeed in life. How are you and what are you doing in your everyday living?

I want to tell you about my success since we left each other. I started a business in selling different things like clothes, food items and hardware items. My business has flourished and succeeded a lot. This has come through hardworking. As my friend, I would like to encourage you to work hard in everything you do for you to succeed.

There are some of the things you need not to do for you to succeed. Some of these things are smoking, drinking beer and chasing girls. I want you to come over to my place and see how I have succeeded in life. Finally, I will be expecting you to visit my place one day.

Yours,

Chisomo.

EXERCISE 15

For practice, answer the questions that follow:

(i). Write a letter to your friend telling him/her the importance of having an HIV test. Use the following questions to guide you:

Paragraph 1

- Why is it important to go for HIV testing?
- Where do people go in your area for HIV testing?

Paragraph 2

- Why do some people avoid going for HIV testing?
- Have you ever gone for HIV testing?

Paragraph 3

- What are the disadvantages of not going for an HIV test?
- What can be done to encourage more people to go for HIV testing?

(ii). You are at a new school this year. Write a letter to your friend at the school where you were last year. Tell him/her about your new school. You may include the following points:

Paragraph 1

- What is the name of your new school?
- Where is the school?
- How big is the school? (for example, number of teachers, learners and classrooms)

Paragraph 2

- What do you learn at your school?
- Which games do you play at the school?

Paragraph 3

- Do you like your new school?
- What do you like/do not like about the school?

(MIE, Malawi Primary Education, English Learners' book for Standard 7, Pages 3-4)

2. BUSINESS LETTER

- This is a letter which is addressed to an office or organization.

- It is also called an official letter.

FEATURES OF A BUSINESS LETTER

A business letter has the following features:

- Two addresses (sender's address and recipient address).
- A date written under the first address.
- Salutation.
- Title or topic.
- Introduction.
- Body or development.
- Conclusion.
- Ending or valediction.

(a). ADDRESSES AND A DATE

- The business letter has two addresses, the address where the letter is coming from and other one showing where the letter is going to. The date is written one line down the sender's address.
- The address where the letter is coming from is written on the upper right corner of the page.
- The address where the letter is going to is written on the left corner of the page below the first address by skipping one line.

Kayola Primary School
Post Office Box 19
Mwazisi
Rumphi.

17th May, 2021.

The General Manager
Airport Development Limited
Private Bag 1320
Lilongwe

(b). SALUTATION

- The salutation of a business letter is written differently to that of a friendly letter.
- It indicates either “Sir” or “madam” because the letter is addressed to an office.
- Do not use “Dear Sir/Madam” rather use either “Dear Sir” or “Dear Madam”
- Skip a line from recipient’s address.
- A comma must be put soon after the recipient title.

(c). TITLE OR TOPIC

- The title of the letter should be short.
- It must be written from the margin.
- It can be written in two different ways as follows:

  (i). in capital letters and not underlined.

  (ii). In small letters and underlined.

Examples

(i). Write a letter to the General Manager of Airport Development Limited, P.O. Box 1320, Lilongwe. In your letter request permission for your class to visit Chileka Airport.

The best title for this letter could be ***"A REQUEST FOR PERMISSION TO VISIT THE AIRPORT" or "A request for permission to visit the airport"***

(ii). Bookkeeper required, qualifications: PSLCE or JCE, write to the General Manager, P.O. Box 70, Likhubula.

In this case, the best title could be ***"APPLICATION FOR THE POST OF BOOKKEEPER" or "Application for the post of bookkeeper"***

(iii). Write a letter to the police. Inform them about the lost cell phone you reported lost but is now found.

The title for the above instruction could be "***THE LOST CELL PHONE" or "The lost cell phone"***

(d). INTRODUCTION

- The introduction of a business letter usually captures what is going to be explained in the body of the letter.
- It must be written from the margin.
- Skip a line from the salutation.
- At primary school level, it is attached to the first paragraph of the body.

Examples

(i). "I write to ask for permission to visit the airport" or "I would like to ask for permission to visit the airport"

(ii). "I write to apply for the position of a bookkeeper at your organisation" or "I would like to apply for a job as a bookkeeper at your organisation"

(iii). "I write to inform you about the cell phone which was lost but now is found" or "I would like to let you know about the cell phone which was reported lost but is now found"

(e). BODY OR DEVELOPMENT

- This is where the details of the letter are explained.
- The body should have three paragraphs.
- Skip a line before starting another paragraph.
- At Primary School Leaving Certificate (PSLC) level, the body is written following guidelines or guiding questions that are given.

(f). CONCLUSION

- This brings the letter to an end.
- The conclusion should be part of paragraph three.
- The letter can be concluded in different ways.

Examples

- If considered, I promise to work very hard.
- I am looking forward to hearing from you soon.
- If favourably considered, I promise to work to the maximum of my capacity.

(g). ENDING OR VALEDICTION

- The ending of a business letter usually comprises "Yours faithfully" and your names in full.
- It is written one line down the last paragraph, that means, you skip one line.

Example

Yours faithfully,

Lumbani Gondwe.

A SAMPLE QUESTION AND ITS MODEL ANSWER

Write a letter to the District Health Officer. In your letter inform him/her about the outbreak of a disease in your area. You may include the following information:

Paragraph 1

- Name of the area in which there is an outbreak of a disease.
- Name of the disease (if known).
- Symptoms of the disease

Paragraph 2

- People affected by the disease.
- What you have done so far to control further spread of the disease.

Paragraph 3

- What you want the District Health Officer to do.
- When you want the assistance.

(MIE, Malawi Primary Education, English Leaners' book for Standard 7, Pages 57-58)

MODEL ANSWER

Kamphenda Primary School
Post Office Box 16
Kamphenda
Rumphi.

18th May, 2021.

The District Health Officer
Rumphi District Hospital
Private Bag 18
Rumphi.

Dear Madam,

AN OUTBREAK OF A DISEASE

I write to inform you about an outbreak of a disease which has affected my area. The name of the area in which there is an outbreak of the disease is Waliro, the area located between Kamphenda and Mwazisi.The name of the disease that has affected the area is Cholera, and some of its symptoms are diarrhoea, dehydration and sunken eyes.

The disease has affected a lot of people in the area. This is so because some people are busy caring for the ones who have been infected by the disease. To avoid further spread of the disease, I have advised people in my area to frequently wash hands with soap and use latrines or toilets when need arises.

I would like you to send the health personnel to my area so that they should establish the extent of the disease and see how best they can handle it. The assistance is needed urgently as the disease is fast spreading. Your attention to this will be appreciated.

Yours faithfully,

Portia Gondwe.

EXERCISE 16

For Practice, answer the following:

(i). Write a letter to the General Manager of Airport Development Limited, P.O. Box 1320, Lilongwe. In your letter request permission for your class to visit Chileka Airport. You may include the following information.

Paragraph 1

- Date and time when you want to visit the airport.
- Number of people who will be in the group.

Paragraph 2

- Purpose of the visit.
- Other areas to visit at the airport.

Paragraph 3

- A request for a reply to your letter.

(MIE, Malawi Primary Education, English Leaners' book for Standard 7, page 32)

(ii). An important hospital in your area has been washed away due to heavy rains. Write a letter to your Member of Parliament asking for assistance to have another hospital constructed. In your letter include the following information:

Paragraph 1

- Where the hospital was.
- When it was washed away.
- Why you think it was washed away.

Paragraph 2

- When the hospital was built.
- **Three** reasons why the hospital was important to your area.

Paragraph 3

- Give an explanation of what is going to happen if a new hospital is not quickly constructed.

(Mchengawedi Zone, 2015, English Mock Examinations, page 2)

(iii). Imagine that you read an advertisement that appeared in Tikhoza Newspaper in Chisomo Company is looking for a shopkeeper. Write a letter applying for the job using the following address: The General Manager, Chisomo Company, P.O. Box 2129, Chokwanira.

In your letter include the following points:

Paragraph 1

- The date you read the advertisement
- Indicate whether you are male or female
- Indicate your age
- Qualification you have

Paragraph 2

- **Two** reasons why you want the job
- Responsibility you had at school related to this job

Paragraph 3

- Things you like doing when you are free
- **Two** things you promise to do for the Company when you start the job

(MANEB, 2014, PSLCE English Paper, Page 2)

REPORT WRITING

- A report is an account presented to the audience or authority for decision making.
- The report uses the same principles as letter writing except for the following:
    - ✓ The date comes on top.
    - ✓ It is clearly marked **"TO"** and **"FROM"**.
    - ✓ The addresses are wrapped in sentence order.
    - ✓ The subject is clearly marked **"subject"**
    - ✓ At the end just write your signature and name in full.

SAMPLE REPORT QUESTION AND MODEL ANSWER

Imagine that you witnessed a fire accident at your school which destroyed the headteacher's office. The police have asked you to give them information on the accident.

In your report include the following points:

Paragraph 1

- Where the fire accident happened
- What caused the fire
- Where you were at the time the fire started

Paragraph 2

- What the Headteacher was doing at the time the fire started

- What **two** helpful things you did during the accident

Paragraph 3

- **Two** things which were burnt by the fire
- **Two** problems that the accident has caused to your school

MODEL ANSWER

Date: 20th September, 2019.

From: Uwemi Gondwe, Waliro Primary School, Post Office Box 39, Kamphenda, Rumphi.

To: The Officer-Incharge, Rumphi Police Station, Post Office Box 11, Rumphi.

Subject: FIRE ACCIDENT

I would like to report to your office about the fire accident that took place at my school. The accident happened on 29th August, 2019 at nine o'clock in the morning. The cause of the fire has not been established yet. I was mopping in the staffroom with my friends when the fire started.

The Headteacher was addressing the School Management Committee under a mango tree shade when the fire started. During the accident, I shouted for help, then I managed to rescue three cartons of standard eight English books.

The headteacher's file for administrative records and a sewing machine were burnt by the fire. The fire brought with it several problems. Firstly, teachers' particulars are missing as they were destroyed by the fire. Secondly, Support Mother Groups are failing to sew sanitary pads and face masks due to the damage of the sewing machine.

I hope you will treat this problem with urgency and seriousness.

Uwemi Gondwe

(MANEB PSLCE, 2016)

EXERCISE 17

For practice, do the following exercises on report writing

1. Thieves came and stole several items at your school. Write a report which you would send to Police. You may use the following information:

   Paragraph 1

   - Date and time when the thieves came to your school
   - Number of thieves who came
   - Weapons they used

   Paragraph 2

   - Details of school materials they stole
   - How they carried the materials away
   - Direction they took when going away

   Paragraph 3

   - What you did when the theft took place

(MIE, Malawi Primary Education, English Learners' book for standard 7, Pages 68-69)

2. You saw Muliyani and Masozi removing the sign post near Mperere Bridge. Write a report to the Police. You may use the following notes to guide you:

Paragraph 1

- The day and time you saw them
- What you were doing near the scene
- The names of other people you were with

Paragraph 2

- What you saw
- From where they took the road sign

Paragraph 3

- What you did when you saw them

(MIE, Malawi Primary Education, English Learners' book for standard 6, Page 13)

3. Write a report on a successful business in your area. Use the following questions to guide you:

Paragraph 1

- What is the name of the business?
- Who is its owner?

- For how long has he or she owned the business?

Paragraph 2

- What type of goods are sold?
- What tings make the business prosper?

Paragraph 3

- What problems do you think the owner faces?
- What successes has the owner achieved?

(MIE, Malawi Primary Education, English Learners' book for standard 6, page 9

SPEECH

- A speech is an oral presentation by the speaker to the audience.

COMPONENTS OF A SPEECH

The speech has the following components or essential parts:

- Title
- Salutation
- Introduction

- Body
- Conclusion
- Ending

1. **TITLE**

- The title of a speech may be written in two different ways as follows:
  - ✓ Block letters

When the title is written in block letters, it is not supposed to be underlined.

  - ✓ Small letters

When it is written in small letters, it is supposed to be underlined. However, the first letter of the title must be capitalised.

2. **SALUTATION**

- ✓ The salutation of the speech usually recognizes a list of dignitaries. Dignitaries are the people of different positions who have come to listen to the speech.
- ✓ The recognition of the dignitaries should always be given in order of importance or authority, i.e, from the dignitary with the highest position to the one with the lowest position.
- ✓ It should be noted that the salutation should be written from the margin. For Example, at a school function where the Headteacher is the highest dignitary, the salutation would be as follows:

The Headteacher

The Deputy Headteacher

Section heads

Teachers

The Prefects

and Learners.

- ✓ The salutation can be punctuated or not.

3. INTRODUCTION

- ✓ The introduction gives the overview of what is going to be said in the main body.
- ✓ In speech, an introduction must have at least two sentences.
- ✓ The first sentence shows gratitude for a given opportunity to speak on behalf of other people or fellow leaners.
- ✓ The second sentence gives an overview of what is going to be said in the main body.
- ✓ It should be a stand-alone paragraph. For example;

It gives me a great opportunity to stand in front of you to make a speech on behalf of my fellow learners. I would like to talk to you on the importance of going for HIV testing and counselling.

4. BODY

- ✓ Usually, at primary level, the body is guided by the questions or guidelines that are given.
- ✓ The first person pronoun “I” is used because the speech is told from the first person point of view.

5. **CONCLUSION**

- ✓ This wraps up what has been said already.
- ✓ It can be part of paragraph 3.

6. **ENDING**

- ✓ To end a speech, the salutation is repeated but this time in general way. You can recognise the highest dignitary and the audience in general. For example;

  The Headteacher and the audience at large, thank you for listening to my speech.

Example

Imagine you have been asked to make a speech on an open day about the transmission and prevention of HIV and AIDS. Include the following in your speech:

Paragraph 1

- Describe HIV and AIDS

Paragraph 2

- How HIV and AIDS is spread

Paragraph 3

- How HIV and AIDS is prevented

MODEL ANSWER

SPREAD AND PREVENTION OF HIV AND AIDS

The Headteacher

The School Management Committee

The Village heads

All leaders gathered here

Ladies and Gentlemen

My Fellow learners

It gives me a great opportunity and pleasure to talk to you on behalf of my fellow learners. I would like to talk to you on how HIV and AIDS is spread and prevented, and I hope you are going to be with me up to the end of my speech.

HIV and AIDS is a deadly disease. Of course, other diseases are deadly but HIV and AIDS is the deadliest because it is a multitude of diseases. In addition to that, it has no cure.

HIV and AIDS is spread in different ways. The most popular way of contracting this disease is through unprotected sexual intercourse. There are also other ways such as sharing of sharp objects like razor blades and ear-piercing needles.

HIV and AIDS is preventable. So I would like to share with you some of the ways through which HIV and AIDS can be prevented. The most effective way is abstinence from sexual activities. The second one is by being faithful to one uninfected partner and the other one is by using condoms. My fellow learners, let us abstain from sexual intercourse in order to have a generation free of HIV and AIDS which will contribute to the development of our country.

The Headteacher and the audience at large, thank you very much for listening to my speech.

EXERCISE 18

For practice, answer the following questions:

(i). Think of a good citizen in your area and write a speech on him or her. You may use the following notes to guide you:

Paragraph 1

- Name of the good citizen
- Where the citizen lives

Paragraph 2

- Examples of what the good citizen does, for example,
  - Acceptable bahaviour
  - Serves the community directly
  - Works with other people for the good of all
  - Helps to protect the people of the country and their property

Paragraph 3

- Why you like the good citizen

(MIE, Malawi Primary Education, English Learners' book for Standard 8,

page 60)

(ii). Imagine that you have been selected to a secondary school. The Headteacher of your school wants you to talk to your fellow students during the assembly about the last day at primary school. Write a speech which you will make during the assembly.

In your speech, include the following:

Paragraph 1

- Your name
- Name of your primary school
- Date you had the closing day activities

Paragraph 2

- Any two organisers of the day
- People who came to the school
- Any two activities that took place on this day

Paragraph 3

- Name of the guest of honour who addressed the learners
- Two key points in the speech from the guest of honour
- A lesson you learned from the activities on the closing day

(MANEB, 2019, PSLCE English Paper, Page 2)

ANSWERS TO THE EXERCISES

EXERCISE 1

1. C
2. A
3. C
4. A
5. D
6. B
7. D
8. B
9. A
10. D
11. B
12. C
13. D
14. A
15. B
16. B
17. D
18. C
19. B
20. B

EXERCISE 2

The---**Article**

World---**Noun**

of---**Preposition**

when---**Adverb**

I---**Pronoun**

was---**Verb**

fashion---**Noun**

is---**Verb**

interesting---**Adjective**

fashions---**Noun**

come---**Verb**

and---**Conjunction**

go---**Verb**

again---**Adverb**

For---**Preposition**

example---**Noun**

dresses---**Noun**

pointed---**Adjective**

shoes---**Noun**

and---**Conjunction**

afro-wigs---**Noun**

were---**Verb**

some---**Pronoun**

of---**Preposition**

the---**Article**

fashions---**Noun**

that---**Pronoun**

my---**Adjective**

mother---**Noun**

a---**Article**

child---**Noun**

I---**Pronoun**

used---**Verb**

to wear---Infintive+Verb=**Verb**

my---Adjective

mother's---**Adjective**

old---**Adjective**

clothes---**Noun**

long---**Adjective**

she---**Pronoun**

used---**Verb**

to tell---Infinitive+verb=**Verb**

us---**Pronoun**

about---**Preposition**

how---**Adverb**

beautiful---**Adjective**

she---**Pronoun**

looked---**Verb**

in---**Preposition**

those---**Adjective**

clothes---**Noun**

used---**Verb**

to wear---Infinitive+verb=**Verb**

my---**Adjective**

mother---**Noun**

was---**Verb**

proud---**Adjective**

to show---Infinitive+verb=**Verb**

off---**Preposition**

her---**Adjective**

items---**Noun**

EXERCISE 3

PUNCTUATION

1. The boy's books are missing.
2. What type of music do you like listening to?
3. She bought mangoes, oranges and guavas.
4. Hey! That's not good.
5. Yankho is a standard 7 learner.
6. "Temwa and Chifundo are my friends," Said Juliet.
7. Who wrote this book?
8. Oh! He has fallen.
9. Lumbani is her father's favourite.
10. This is Mary's mother.
11. In which class are you?

12. “Stop!” They shouted together.
13. My daughter, Uwemi, is a nurse.
14. Lumbani bought the following items: soap, lotion, beef and butter.
15. Who are you waiting for?

EXERCISE 4

MAKING SENTENCES

Questions 1-50, answers will vary

EXERCISE 5

Question tags

1. C
2. D
3. A
4. C
5. C
6. A
7. D
8. B
9. A
10. C
11. A
12. D
13. C
14. B
15. A

EXERCISE 6

PROVERBS

1. B
2. D
3. A
4. D
5. D

6. B
7. A
8. C
9. B
10. D
11. C
12. D

EXERCISE 7

SIMILES

1. B
2. A
3. D
4. C
5. A
6. C
7. B
8. D
9. A
10. C
11. B
12. D
13. C
14. A
15. C
16. B
17. B
18. A
19. C
20. A

EXERCISE 8

PHRASAL VERBS

1. C
2. A
3. A
4. A
5. C
6. B
7. D
8. C
9. A
10. B
11. B
12. B
13. D
14. B
15. B

EXERCISE 9

COMPREHENSION

1. It is near Mperere river.
2. (i) Vegetables (ii) maize
3. (i) Rails (ii) iron sheets

4. Durani and Sanzira
5. (i) it means “washed away” (ii) it means coming closer
6. It is beacause Umodzi’s uncle fell sick so they wanted to take him to hospital by ambulance.
7. Removal/damage of the sign post.

EXERCISE 10

CLAUSES

1. C
2. D
3. B
4. C
5. B
6. A
7. D
8. B
9. D
10. C
11. C
12. B
13. A
14. C
15. A

EXERCISE 11

CONDITIONAL SENTENCES

1. A
2. B
3. C
4. D
5. D
6. C
7. B
8. A
9. B
10. A

EXERCISE 12

DIRECT AND INDIRECT SPEECH

1. He said that they produced many crops in that area.
2. Lumbani said that they had a lot of promises but no development.
3. She told us not to leave the room.
4. He said that thangata system was bad.
5. Uwemi said that her mother works in the bank.
6. Tadala said that she had come to see me the night before.
7. He asked me if he might return the book the following day.

8. John said that he would come the next day.
9. Her mother said that Mary had gone to the hospital the day before.
10. A police officer warned our minibus driver not to drink and drive.
11. The Headteacher announced that there was a holiday the following day.
12. I told the visitor that my father went to work every day.
13. Jane told us that she had a feeling that we would win the game.
14. The judge asked Landani if he admitted the charges levelled against him in the court.
15. Chisomo commanded us to stop what we were doing.
16. She requested me if I could go there.
17. The Officer In-charge commanded us to go and arrest them.
18. She said that her name was Lumbani.
19. He requested us if we could leave him alone.
20. They requested us if we could lend them some money.

EXERCISE 13

ACTIVE AND PASSIVE VOICES

1. The sports festival was hosted by our school.
2. The function will be opened by the Headteacher.

3. The guest of honour was accompanied by the Traditional Authority.
4. The oranges were eaten by Uwemi.
5. The winners were given prizes by the director.
6. Football was being watched by him.
7. The teams were cheered for by the supporters.
8. Had the subject been taught by the teacher?
9. Uwemi was elected secretary by the committee.
10. English will have been taught by him by 8 am.
11. The president had been seen by them.
12. The clothes were being washed by us.
13. My house had been inherited by her.
14. The law had been declared unconstitutional by the court.
15. The trophy was won by our school.

EXERCISE 14

COMPOSITION

(i) Answers will vary

(ii) Answers will vary

(iii) Answers will vary

(iv) Answers will vary

(v) Answers will vary

EXERCISE 15

LETTER WRITING (FRIENDLY LETTER)

(i) Answers will vary

(ii) Answers will vary

EXERCISE 16

LETTER WRITING (BUSINESS LETTER)

(i) Answers will vary

(ii) Answers will vary

(iii) Answers will vary

EXERCISE 17

REPORT WRITING

1. Answers will vary
2. Answers will vary
3. Answers will vary

EXERCISE 18

WRITING A SPEECH

(i) Answers will vary

(ii) Answers will vary

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